

Scaling Operations Guide

The Cleaning CEO Blueprint — 100% Cleaner Academy

Scaling a cleaning company means shifting from **doing the work** to **designing the system** that does the work. This guide covers multi-team dispatch, KPIs, virtual assistants, automation, and geographic expansion.

The Scaling Phases

Phase	Revenue	Team	Your Role
Solo	\$0–\$8K/mo	Just you	Cleaner + sales + admin
Builder	\$8K–\$25K/mo	1–3 cleaners	Trainer + scheduler
Operator	\$25K–\$75K/mo	4–10 cleaners	Manager + systems
CEO	\$75K+/mo	Multi-team, VAs	Strategy + leadership

You cannot skip phases. Hiring 10 cleaners before SOPs exist creates chaos, not scale.

Multi-Team Dispatch

When You Need Dispatch

- 4+ cleaners working same day
- Jobs across multiple cities
- Team cleans (2-person move-outs)
- You can't hold the schedule in your head

Dispatch Board Structure

Organize by **day → zone → cleaner → jobs**

MONDAY – NORTH ZONE

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| — Sarah (Lead)
|   | — 9:00 – Johnson (Regular $150)
|   | — 11:30 – Martinez (Regular $150)
|   | — 2:00 – Chen (Deep $300)
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└─ Mike
| └─ 9:00 – Williams (Regular \$150)
| └─ 12:00 – Park (Move-Out \$450) + Lisa (helper)

Dispatch Rules

Rule	Why
Cluster by zip code	Minimize drive time
Max 4–5 jobs per cleaner/day	Quality degrades after that
30-min buffer between jobs	Overruns happen
Match skill to job type	Deep/move-out = experienced only
Same cleaner for recurring	Client retention
Publish schedule 7 days ahead	Team planning

Tools for Dispatch

Tool	Best For
Jobber	Auto-routing, drag-drop dispatch
Housecall Pro	Team view, GPS
ZenMaid	Cleaning-specific scheduling
Google Sheets	Under \$15K/mo (free, manual)

Daily Dispatch Ritual (15 min)

- 1. Review tomorrow's schedule — gaps, conflicts, new bookings
- 2. Assign backups for high-risk slots (new clients, difficult homes)
- 3. Send schedule to team chat by 6 PM prior day
- 4. Morning check: all arrival check-ins received by 9:30 AM

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

Company-Level KPIs (Weekly Dashboard)

KPI	Formula	Target
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Revenue	Sum of completed jobs	Trending up MoM
Gross margin	(Revenue - cleaner pay - supplies) / Revenue	25–35%
Utilization	Booked hours / available hours	75–85%
Callback rate	Re-cleans / total jobs	< 5%
Client retention	Recurring clients retained / total	> 85% quarterly
Average ticket	Revenue / jobs	\$160–\$220 residential
Lead-to-book	Booked / total leads	> 30%
No-show rate	Missed appointments / scheduled	< 3%

Marketing KPIs

KPI	Target
Cost per lead (CPL)	< \$25
Cost per acquired customer (CAC)	< \$100 or < 1 job profit
Google review velocity	4+ new/month
Website conversion	5–15% of visitors book

Team KPIs (Per Cleaner)

See [Team Management Guide](#) — track on-time %, photo compliance, ratings, call-offs.

KPI Review Cadence

Meeting	Frequency	Who
Flash metrics	Daily (5 min)	Owner — revenue, schedule gaps
Weekly ops review	Weekly (30 min)	Owner + lead
Monthly P&L	Monthly (1 hr)	Owner + bookkeeper
Quarterly strategy	Quarterly (2 hr)	Leadership

Virtual Assistants (VAs)

When to Hire a VA

- You spend 10+ hours/week on scheduling, emails, and data entry
- Missed calls are costing you \$500+/week in lost bookings
- Revenue supports \$1,500–\$3,000/mo for part-time help

VA Task List (Cleaning Company)

Task	Hours/Week	Priority
Answer calls / return voicemails	5–10	High
Schedule jobs in booking software	3–5	High
Send confirmation/reminder texts	2–3	High
Process payments / follow failed cards	2–3	High
Respond to Yelp/Google messages	2–4	Medium
Update CRM notes	2–3	Medium
Request reviews (happy clients only)	1–2	Medium
Social media posts (from templates)	2–3	Low
Light bookkeeping data entry	3–5	Medium

VA Hiring

Source	Rate
OnlineJobs.ph (Philippines)	\$5–\$10/hr
Belay	\$20+/hr (US)
Upwork	Varies
Local part-time	\$15–\$22/hr

VA Onboarding Checklist

- ☐ Access to scheduling software (limited permissions)
- ☐ Phone system (Grasshopper, OpenPhone, RingCentral)
- ☐ Script library ([phone](#), [text](#), [email](#))
- ☐ FAQ doc (pricing, policies, service area)
- ☐ Escalation rules (complaints → owner immediately)
- ☐ No access to bank accounts or full financials initially

VA KPIs

Metric	Target
Call answer rate	90%+
Response time (messages)	< 1 hour
Scheduling errors	< 2/month
Client complaints about VA	0

Automation Stack

Automate These First (Highest ROI)

Process	Tool	Trigger
Booking confirmation	Jobber/Square/ZenMaid	New booking
48-hr reminder	Same	48 hrs before
Day-before reminder	Same	24 hrs before
Review request	Zapier + CRM	24 hrs after job, if rating positive
Payment after service	Stripe/Square	Job marked complete
Failed payment retry	Stripe	Auto-retry 3x
New lead notification	Slack/email	Form submission

Zapier / Make Automation Examples

Trigger: Job marked "Complete" in Jobber
→ Wait 24 hours
→ Send SMS review request (if no complaint logged)

Trigger: New Google Form intake
→ Create client in CRM
→ Notify VA in Slack
→ Send quote email template

What NOT to Automate (Keep Human)

- Complaint resolution
 - Custom quotes for unusual homes
 - Termination conversations
 - Pricing negotiations
 - Damage claims
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Standard Operating at Scale

Document Everything (Modules 5–9)

At scale, your business runs on:

- SOPs for every service type
- Checklists for every job phase
- Hiring and onboarding system
- Storage and inventory system
- Payment and cancellation policies
- Customer communication templates

If it's not documented, it doesn't scale.

Quality Control at Scale

Volume	QC Method
1–3 cleaners	Owner spot-checks 2 jobs/week
4–8 cleaners	Lead cleaner inspections + photo audits
9+ cleaners	Dedicated QC role, random 20% inspection rate

Financial Controls

- Weekly revenue reconciliation (bookings vs. bank deposits)
 - Cleaner pay audit monthly
 - Supply cost per job tracked quarterly
 - Separate business accounts always
 - Owner salary line item (pay yourself)
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Geographic Expansion

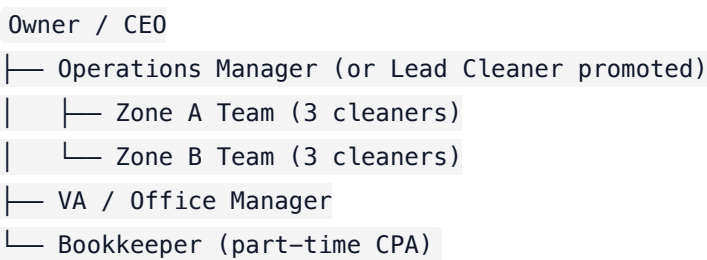
When to Expand to a New City

- Existing zone at 85%+ utilization
- Turning away clients in adjacent city
- You have a lead cleaner willing to manage new zone

Expansion Playbook

1. **Map service radius** — 30-minute max drive from storage
2. **Hire local cleaner** in new zone first (they know the area)
3. **Marketing localized** — Google Business Profile service area, Yelp, Nextdoor
4. **Storage** — second unit or mobile restock from lead's vehicle
5. **Don't expand until current zone is profitable**

Multi-City Org Structure



Technology Stack at Scale

Function	Starter	Scale
Booking	Square	Jobber / Housecall Pro
Payments	Square / Stripe	Stripe + subscriptions
Communication	iMessage group	Slack / Connecteam
CRM	Spreadsheet	Jobber CRM / HubSpot
Accounting	Wave	QuickBooks Online
Payroll	Manual / Gusto	Gusto
Phone	Personal cell	OpenPhone

Automation	None	Zapier
Marketing	Manual posts	VA + Canva templates

Hiring for Scale

Role	When to Hire	Monthly Cost
2nd cleaner	Turning away jobs	Per job
Lead cleaner	3+ cleaners	+\$200–\$400 stipend
VA	10+ hrs admin/week	\$800–\$2,500
Operations manager	\$50K+/mo revenue	\$3,500–\$5,000
Dedicated salesperson	Commercial focus	Commission

Promote from within when possible — your best lead cleaner knows your standards.

Common Scaling Mistakes

Mistake	Fix
Hiring before systems	Document SOPs first
Underpricing at volume	Raise prices as demand grows
Owner still cleaning	Set "last clean date" and stick to it
No financial reporting	Monthly P&L non-negotiable
Ignoring callbacks	Track and coach — callbacks kill margins
Expanding too fast geographically	Dominate one zone first
No owner salary	Pay yourself or you're subsidizing

12-Month Scaling Roadmap

Month	Focus	Milestone
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1–2	SOPs + first hire	2 cleaners, documented processes
3–4	Recurring revenue	60% recurring clients
5–6	VA + automation	Owner out of daily scheduling
7–8	Lead cleaner + QC	Callback rate < 5%
9–10	Marketing scale	Profitable paid ads
11–12	Second zone or commercial	Revenue \$50K+/mo

CEO Time Allocation (At Scale)

Activity	% of Week
Strategy & growth	30%
Team leadership (1-on-1s, training)	25%
Key client relationships	15%
Financial review	10%
Marketing oversight	10%
Cleaning (emergency only)	0–5%
Admin	0% (delegated)

The Ultimate Scaling Test

Can your business run for two weeks without you?

If not, you're self-employed. If yes, you're building a company.

Systems → People → KPIs → Automation → Freedom.

Scale with discipline, not desperation. 100% Cleaner / The Cleaning CEO Blueprint.